

FAST STROKE ASSESSMENT TOOL

Face Arm Speech Time Protocol for Suspected Acute Stroke

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

FAST ASSESSMENT DOMAINS

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
F - Facial Droop Ask patient to smile or show teeth	☐ Normal: Symmetrical smile and facial movement (0) ☐ Abnormal: One side of face droops or is numb (1)	[]
A - Arm Weakness Raise both arms forward, palms up, 10s	☐ Normal: Both arms stay up equally for 10 seconds (0) ☐ Abnormal: One arm drifts downward or is paralyzed (1)	[]
S - Speech Difficulty Ask patient to repeat simple sentence	☐ Normal: Repeats simple sentence correctly without slurring (0) ☐ Abnormal: Slurred speech, wrong words, or unable to speak (1)	[]
T - Time to Act Time of onset / last known well	☐ Time of symptom onset recorded: ____:____ (Emergency EMS / Stroke Alert) (0)	[]

Emergency Acute Stroke Management Protocol:

- Exact Time of Last Known Well (LKW): ____:____ (Crucial for thrombolytic window < 4.5 hours and thrombectomy < 24 hours).
- Immediate Bedside Fingerstick Glucose: Rule out hypoglycemia (if < 60 mg/dL, treat immediately with 50% dextrose).
- Stat Neurovascular Imaging: Urgent non-contrast head CT + CTA head/neck to exclude hemorrhage and identify LVO.

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: Stroke Positive / Negative)

Assessor (RN / License #): _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

Stroke Unlikely (0 Symptoms)

Alternative diagnostic evaluation (hypoglycemia check, Bell palsy, migraine).

Acute Stroke Alert! (≥ 1 Symptom Present)

Time is Brain! Immediate Code Stroke, neuroimaging (CT/MRI), IV thrombolysis / thrombectomy pathway.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment